

having to constantly scroll between them. This problem is solved in OpenOffice by opening New Windows from the Window menu to display the same document. The multiple open documents can then be cascaded and arranged as desired, and any change made in one open version of the document is reflected in all open copies so you can access different parts of the same document simultaneously with all changes being integrated to one copy.

Customise Events: Many expert users of Microsoft Office use macros to make their work easier but casual users rarely bother with the complexity. OpenOffice makes this feature easy to use and valuable through its Events menu. You can record macro instructions telling the program what action to take in case of specific situations e.g. if your page count goes over two pages, you can instruct the macro to insert page numbers. Many such actions can be assigned by going to the Tools menu and selecting Events under Customisation.

Default MS Office: You may enjoy working in OpenOffice but you need your files to be compatible with Microsoft's Office suite and converting the ODT format every time isn't a very clean or desirable means of doing that. An easy option built into OpenOffice is the ability to change the default save format of a document. Go to Tools and select Options under it, then locate the Load/Save category and the General sub-category. In the Document Type drop down menu select Text Document and in the Always Save As drop down menu select Microsoft Word 97/2000/XP, do the same for the Spreadsheet option. Now all files will be saved in the MS Office file format by default.

Hidden Hello: OpenOffice is made by a core team of dedicated developers who believe in the open source movement. However they remain faceless and nameless in most instances. But if you want you can see who these people are you can by inserting the following value in a spreadsheet cell - `"=starcalc-team()"` - this will launch a display pic of all the developers enjoying a picnic.

iWork

It's no secret that iWorks is the runt of the litter when we begin to compare office suites. Its features may not be as comprehensive or easily upgradeable as PC based office suites. But iWorks does make your documents, spreadsheets and presentations look damn good. And if you have a Mac machine with limited options and not a pressing need for a heavy duty office suite, the free giveaway of iWorks with the Maverick upgrade has been a gift from Apple to you. Now all that remains is making the most of the application, so here a few tricks to get you working on the iWorks office suite.